

XANTHOCERAS

XYZ

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SAPINDACEAE

Genus of one species of erect, deciduous, spring- to summer-flowering shrub, grown for its foliage and flowers. Fully hardy. Requires a sunny position and fertile, well-drained soil. Does best in areas with hot summers. Propagate by seed sown in fall or by root cuttings or suckers in late winter. Prone to coral spot fungus. **X. sorbifolium** illus. p.112.

XANTHOCYPARIS

CUPRESSACEAE

Genus of conifers with flattened sprays of scalelike adult leaves and larger, linear, young leaves in whorls of four. Fully hardy. Cones are small and spherical. Cultivars of *X. nootkatensis* are striking specimen trees. ☉Contact with foliage may aggravate skin allergies. See also CONIFERS. **X. nootkatensis**, syn. *Chamaecyparis nootkatensis* (Nootka cypress). Almost geometrically conical conifer. H 50ft (15m), S 20ft (6m). Bears long, pendent sprays of scalelike, aromatic, gray-green leaves and globular, hooked, dark blue and green cones that ripen to brown. Z4-7. **‘Pendula’** has a gaunt crown of arching, weeping foliage.

Xanthophthalmum. See *Glebionis*.

XANTHORRHOEA

Blackboy, Grass tree

XANTHORRHOEAACEAE

Genus of evergreen, long-lived perennials, grown mainly as foliage plants. Frost tender. Needs full sun, well-drained soil and a fairly dry atmosphere. Propagate by basal offsets or seed in spring. **X. australis**. Evergreen perennial with a stout, dark trunk. H 2-4ft (60cm-1.2m), S 4-5ft (1.2-1.5m). Very narrow, arching, flattened, silvery-green leaves, 2ft (60cm) or more long, ¼in (2mm) wide, spread from top of the trunk. In summer, may produce small, fragrant, 6-petaled, white flowers, in dense, candlelike spikes, 2ft (60cm) or more long, on stems of similar length. Z10-11 (min. 41°F/5°C)

XANTHOSOMA

ARACEAE

Genus of perennials, with underground tubers or thick stems above ground, grown mainly for their attractive foliage. Many species are cultivated in the tropics for their edible tubers. Frost tender. Needs a position in partial shade and rich, moist soil. Keep in a cantantly moist atmosphere. Propagate by division; alternatively, take stem cuttings in spring or summer. **X. nigrum**. See *X. violaceum*. **X. sagittifolium** illus. p.474. **X. violaceum**, syn. *X. nigrum*. Stemless perennial with large, underground tubers and leaves rising from ground level.

H and S 4ft (1.2m). Purplish leaf stalks, to over 2ft (60cm) long, bear arrow-shaped leaf blades, 28in (70cm) long, dark green with purple midribs and veins. Intermittently bears greenish-purple spathes, yellower within, surrounding a brownish spadix. Z11-12 (min. 55°F/13°C)

XERANTHEMUM

Immortelle

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals. Half hardy. Grow in sun and in fertile, very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring. **X. annuum** [double] illus. p.305.

XEROCHRYSUM

SYN. BRACHTEANTHA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of herbaceous perennials and annuals, grown for their daisylike flower heads with papery bracts. Stalkless, hairy leaves are borne on erect, branching stems. Frost to half hardy. Needs full sun and moderately fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown in spring. *X. bracteatum* is often grown for cutting and drying.

X. bracteatum (Everlasting flower, Immortelle, Strawflower). Moderately fast-growing, upright, branching annual or short-lived perennial. H 4-36in (10-100cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has broadly lance-shaped, mid-green leaves and papery, daisylike flower heads in bright white, yellow, pink, or red from late spring to fall. Flower heads dry well. Z10-11. **Bright Bikini Series**, H and S 1ft (30cm), has double flower heads, to 3in (8cm) across, in red, pink, orange, yellow, or white.

Monstrosum Series cultivars, H 3ft (90cm), have fully double flower heads. **Sundaze Series SUNDAZE GOLD (‘Redbragol’)** illus. p.320.

XEROPHYLLUM

MELANTHIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of elegant, summer-flowering, rhizomatous, clump-forming perennials. Fully hardy. Prefers full sun and moist, peaty soil. May be difficult to cultivate. Propagate by seed in fall. **X. tenax**. Clump-forming perennial. H 3-4ft (1-1.2m), S 1-2ft (30-60cm). Star-shaped, white flowers, with violet anthers, are borne in dense, terminal racemes in summer. Basal leaves are mid-green. Z4-8

YUCCA

SYN. HESPEROYUCCA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for the architectural value of their bold, sword-shaped, clustered leaves and showy panicles of usually white flowers. Good for growing in containers. Fully hardy to frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens moderately; reduce watering when not in full growth. Regularly remove spent flowering stems. Propagate in spring: frost-tender species by seed or suckers, hardier species by root cuttings or division.

Y. aloifolia (Spanish bayonet). Slow-growing, evergreen shrub or small tree with few branches. H 25ft (8m), S 12-15ft (4-5m). Has sword-shaped, deep green leaves, 20-30in (50-75cm) long, and large panicles of purple-tinted, white flowers in summer-fall. Z9-11

Y. filamentosa (Adam’s needle). Clump-forming, evergreen, basal-rosetted shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 5ft (1.5m). From mid- to late summer, produces tall panicles of pendulous, tulip-shaped, white flowers, which rise up through low-growing tufts of sword-shaped, deep green leaves, edged with white threads. Z5-10. **‘Bright Edge’** has leaves with broad yellow margins. Z5-10. **‘Color Guard’** has cream-colored leaves with green margins. **Y. filifera ‘Ivory’**. See *Y. flaccida* ‘Ivory’. **Y. flaccida**. Clump-forming, almost stemless shrub. H 22in (55cm), S 5ft (1.5m). Has basal rosettes of lance-shaped, dark blue-green leaves, to 22in (55cm) long, fringed with curly or straight threads. Bears nodding, bell-shaped white flowers in mid- and late summer. Z6-10. **‘Golden Sword’** has yellow-margined leaves. Z5-10. **‘Ivory’** (syn. *Y. filifera* ‘Ivory’) illus. p.151. **Y. gloriosa** (Spanish dagger) illus. p.132. **‘Variegata’** has yellow-margined leaves. **Y. parviflora**. See *Hesperaloe parviflora*. **Y. whipplei**. See *Hesperoyucca whipplei*.

YUSHANIA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES. **Y. anceps**, syn. *Arundinaria anceps*, *A. jaunsarensis*, *Sinarundinaria jaunsarensis* (Anceps bamboo). Evergreen, spreading bamboo. H 6-10ft (2-3m), S indefinite. Erect, later arching, stems bearing several branches at each node. Z8-11. **‘Pitt White’** illus. p.288.

ZABELIA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs, grown for their foliage and freely borne flowers. Fully to half hardy, but in cold areas does best against a south- or west-facing wall. Requires a sheltered, sunny site and fertile, well-drained soil. Remove dead wood in late spring and prune out older branches after flowering to restrict growth, if needed. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer. **Zabelia triflora**, syn. *Abelia triflora*, illus. p.113.

ZALUZIANSKYA

SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of sticky, low-growing annuals and evergreen perennials and subshrubs, with spikes of fragrant, tubular flowers with spreading petals. Frost hardy to half hardy. Needs full sun and moist, sharply drained, humus-rich soil. Propagate by stem-tip cuttings in summer. **Z. ovata**. Clump-forming, evergreen perennial. H to 10in (25cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Branching, brittle stems bear ovate, toothed, sticky, gray-green leaves. Crimson-backed, white flowers are borne over a long period in summer. Z7-10

ZANTEDESCHIA

Arum lily

ARACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, tuberous or rhizomatous perennials, usually remaining evergreen in a warm climate, grown for their erect, funnel-shaped spathes and club-shaped spadix. Fully hardy to frost tender. Requires full sun or partial shade and well-drained soil. *Z. aethiopica* will also grow in 6-12in (15-30cm) of water and therefore is suitable as a marginal water plant. Propagate by offsets in winter. ☉All parts of the plant may cause mild stomach upset if ingested, and contact with the sap may irritate the skin.

Z. aethiopica (Arum lily). Clump-forming, rhizomatous perennial, evergreen in mild areas. H and S 3ft (90cm). Has semierect, arrow-shaped, glossy, bright green leaves, to 1½ft (45cm) long. In late spring to midsummer, bears a succession of large, pure white spathes, to 10in (25cm) long, with creamy yellow spadices. Z8-10. **‘Crowborough’** illus. p.437. **‘Green Goddess’** illus. p.408.

Z. albomaculata, syn. *Z. melanoleuca*. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 12-16in (30-40cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has arrow-shaped, semierect, basal leaves with transparent spots. Produces a yellow spadix inside a white to cream, pale yellow or pale pink spathe, 5-8in (12-20cm) long, shading to green at the base and with a purple blotch inside. Z10-12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

Z. ‘Black-eyed Beauty’. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 12-16in (30-40cm), S 6in (15cm). Broadly heart-shaped, semierect, mid- to dark green, basal leaves are heavily spotted white. Each flower stem has a yellow spadix and cream spathe, 6in (15cm) long, with a central black mark in the throat. Z10-12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

Z. ‘Black Magic’. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 8in (20cm). Broadly heart-shaped, semierect, mid- to dark green, basal leaves are heavily mottled white. Each flower stem bears a golden-yellow spadix, surrounded by a black-throated, yellow spathe, 6in (15cm) long. Z10-12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

Z. ‘Cameo’ illus. p.395. **Z. elliottiana** (Golden arum lily) illus. p.393.

Z. ‘Garnet Glow’. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 8in (20cm). Produces white-spotted leaves and light red spathes. Z10-12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

Z. ‘Kiwi Blush’. Clump-forming, tuberous perennial. H 2-3ft (60-90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has heart-shaped, mid-green leaves. From mid-spring to late summer, produces thick-textured, white spathes, with pale pink throats maturing to darker pink. Z8-10

Z. melanoleuca. See *Z. albomaculata*. **Z. ‘Picasso’**. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has arrow-shaped, white-spotted leaves. Produces purple spathes with white edges. Z10-12 (min. 41°F/5°C) **Z. rehmannii** (Pink arum). Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 16in (40cm), S 1ft (30cm). Green basal leaves are arrow-shaped and semierect.